



AFTER

Lincoln's death plunged the nation into mourning and opened new wounds at a time when old ones had not yet started to heal.

POLITICAL AFTERSHOCKS

Vice President Andrew Johnson became president. Thus a **Southern Democrat**, drafted to attract swing voters in 1864, now headed a **Republican administration**. Lacking Lincoln's political and moral authority, he was ill-equipped for **the task of Reconstruction** (see [The Reality of Black Freedom](#)).

THE FATE OF THE CONSPIRATORS

Eight suspects went on trial. Held in isolation, their heads were covered in cotton-lined canvas hoods with **a slit for eating but no ear or eyeholes**. Powell, Herold, Atzerodt, and Mary Surratt were condemned to death and **hanged on July 7, 1865**. Three others received sentences of **life imprisonment**, while another, a carpenter at Ford's Theatre accused of **assisting in Booth's escape**, got six years.